TED: The Economics Daily

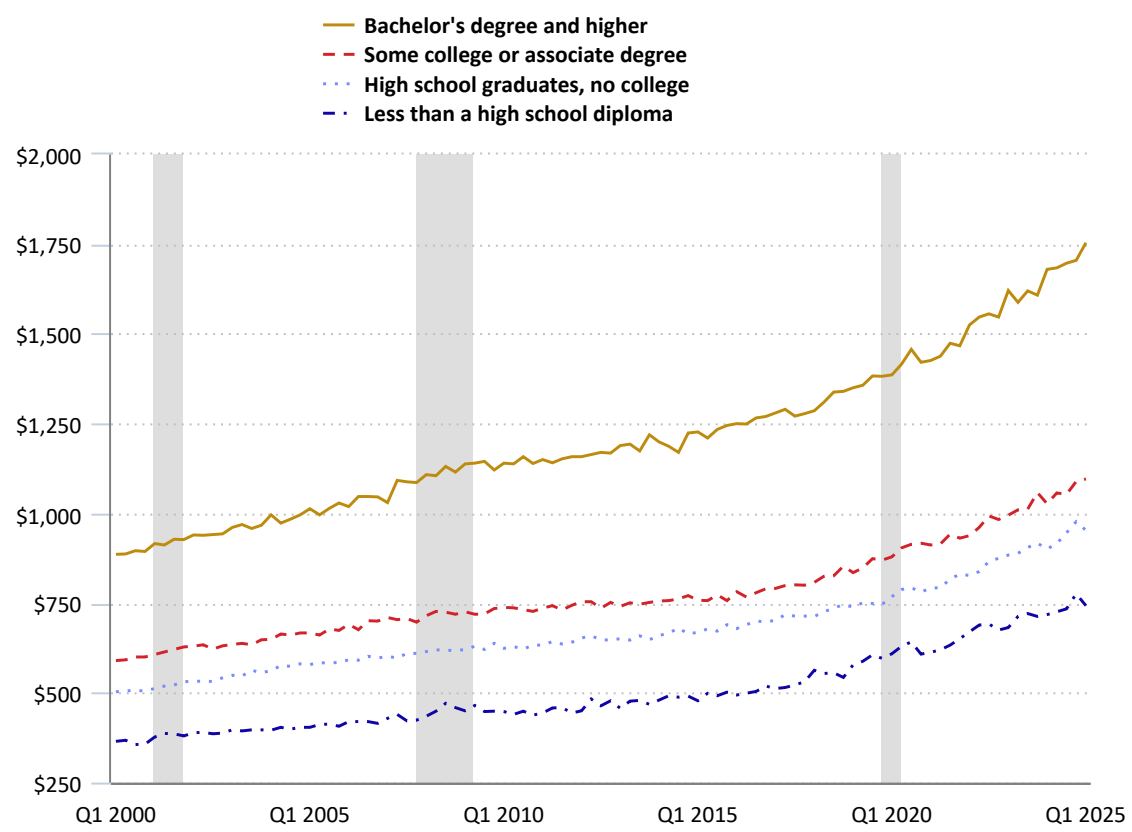
Median weekly earnings by educational attainment, first quarter 2025

April 29, 2025

Median weekly earnings of the nation's 110.8 million full-time wage and salary workers age 25 and over were $1,258 in the first quarter of 2025. This was 5.7 percent higher than a year earlier, compared with a gain of 2.7 percent in the Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers (CPI-U) over the same period. At each level of educational attainment, workers' weekly earnings were around double what they were 25 years earlier, in the first quarter of 2000.

CHART IMAGE CHART DATA

Median usual weekly earnings of full-time wage and salary workers age 25 years and over, by educational attainment, quarterly averages, not seasonally adjusted



Click legend items to change data display. Hover over chart to view data.
Shaded areas represent recessions as determined by the National Bureau of Economic Research.
Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics.

Median usual weekly earnings of full-time wage and salary workers age 25 years and over, by educational attainment, quarterly averages, not seasonally adjusted

Quarter	Less than a high school diploma	High school graduates, no college	Some college or associate degree	Bachelor's degree and higher
Q1 2000	365	503	590	886
Q2 2000	368	506	592	887
Q3 2000	356	506	600	896
Q4 2000	357	506	600	894
Q1 2001	377	512	607	916
Q2 2001	387	519	614	912
Q3 2001	386	522	621	928
Q4 2001	380	531	628	927
Q1 2002	389	533	630	940
Q2 2002	390	532	634	939
Q3 2002	386	532	622	941

In the first quarter of 2025, full-time workers age 25 and over without a high school diploma had median weekly earnings of $743, compared with $718 the previous year. High school graduates with no college education had earnings of $953, up from $901 the prior year.

Those with some college or an associate degree had median weekly earnings of $1,096, compared with $1,027 the previous year. College graduates holding at least a bachelor's degree had median weekly earnings of $1,754, up from $1,680 a year earlier.

These data are from the Current Population Survey and are not seasonally adjusted. For more information, see "Usual Weekly Earnings of Wage and Salary Workers: First Quarter 2025" and more charts of usual weekly earnings data. Full-time workers usually work 35 hours or more per week at their sole or main job. The median is the midpoint in the earnings distribution; half of workers earn more than the median and half earn less.

RELATED SUBJECTS

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SUGGESTED CITATION

Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Department of Labor, *The Economics Daily*, Median weekly earnings by educational attainment, first quarter 2025 at https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2025/median-weekly-earnings-by-educational-attainment-first-quarter-2025.htm (visited *March 02, 2026*).

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